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China OTAs

Resilient Domestic Travel Data and Cross-border Visitor Volume During Dragon Boat Festival

CITI'S TAKE

China's MCT reported travel traffic and industry revenues during the 3-day Dragon Boat Festival of 124mn/Rmb44.5bn, +4.4/+4% yoy growth, implying average spending -0.4% yoy. The national passenger throughput recorded 0.9% yoy decline during the holiday with railway/airline/roadway/waterway +2.9/+0.6/-1.2/-1.8% yoy. China's Immigration Department reported cross-border visitor volume was up 12.9% yoy with Chinese citizen volume up 5.5% yoy, which is in line with the Immigration's projection prior to the holiday. Albeit national passenger throughput data a bit weak, we view overall domestic revs and traffic performance resilient, especially considering the surging airline ticketing price and heavy rain during the holiday, while cross-border data for Chinese citizens also looks resilient despite the oil price impact. Nonetheless, TCOM is scheduled to release its 1Q26 results on 25 Jun HKT, and we expect conservative tone on 2Q26E likely from mgmt given the potential impacts from oil price and investigation. Maintain Buy ratings on TCOM/Tongcheng.

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Details of transportation and cross-border data – During the 3-day holiday, national passenger throughput reached 647.9mn, representing -0.9% yoy, with railway/airline/roadway/waterway +2.9/+0.6/-1.2/-1.8% yoy, respectively, according to data from Ministry of Transport. The data shows the overall passenger throughput likely impacted by heavy rain across China, especially for roadway, while railway performance was relatively more resilient vs. airline which might be dragged by higher airline ticketing prices. Cross-border visitor volume was up 12.9% yoy with Chinese citizens/HK & Macau & Taiwan residents/foreigners volume up 5.5/18.4/23.3% yoy, which performance was resilient especially considering surging oil price impact.

More color from OTAs – TCOM: Trip.com data indicates that during the Dragon Boat Festival holiday, popular major cities and “hidden gem” small towns were top destinations, with female travelers and the post-90s generation leading the trend, predominantly opting for inter-provincial short trips (pls click [link](#), 100EC.cn, 22-Jun 26). **Tongcheng:** Tongcheng indicates that during the Dragon Boat Festival holiday, short-distance “micro-vacations” remained popular, especially in the Jiangsu, Zhejiang, and Shanghai region, with a growing trend towards “hidden gem” small towns and “village-drifting” tourism for relaxed experiences. (pls click [link](#), SinaNews, 22-Jun 26). **Fliggy:** Fliggy indicated a significant increase in per capita booking value and hotel stays during the Dragon Boat Festival, driven by consumers' preference for quality travel and a surge in demand for summer escape and grassland tours in Northwest and Northeast regions. (pls click [link](#), TheCover, 22-Jun 26).

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

Figure 1. Dragon Boat festival travel data in 2026

	2025 New Year	2025 CNY	2025 Qingming	2025 Labour Day	2025 Dragon Boat	2025 National Day
Domestic visitor volume (mn)	135	501	126	314	119	888
yoy growth %	9.4%	5.9%	6.3%	6.4%	5.7%	16.1%
Domestic tourism revs (Rmb bn)	77	677	58	180	43	809
yoy growth %	na	7.0%	6.7%	8.0%	5.9%	15.4%
Average Spending (Rmb)	567	1,351	457	574	359	911
yoy growth %	na	1.0%	0.4%	1.5%	0.2%	-0.6%
	2026 New Year	2026 CNY	2026 Qingming	2026 Labour Day	2026 Dragon Boat	
Domestic visitor volume (mn)	142	596	135	325	124	
yoy growth %	2.6%	19.0%	6.8%	3.6%	4.4%	
Domestic tourism revs (Rmb bn)	85	803	61	185	44	
yoy growth %	3.1%	18.7%	6.6%	2.9%	4.0%	
Average Spending (Rmb)	597	1,348	455	571	359	
yoy growth %	-1.0%	-0.2%	-0.2%	-0.7%	-0.4%	

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Source: Ministry of Culture and Tourism, Citi Research

Figure 2. National passenger throughput data during Dragon Boat Festival

Dragon Boat Festival	Date	Railway	yoy	Airline	yoy	Roadway	yoy	Waterway	yoy	Total	yoy
The day before the holiday	18-Jun	16.7	6.1%	2.2	0.1%	196.5	7.2%	0.6	-5.7%	216.0	7.0%
1st day	19-Jun	19.4	6.9%	1.9	0.0%	209.3	-0.3%	0.9	-10.1%	231.4	0.2%
2nd day	20-Jun	12.1	2.0%	1.7	-2.6%	186.3	-2.1%	1.0	0.8%	201.2	-1.8%
3rd day	21-Jun	17.9	-0.5%	2.1	3.9%	194.5	-1.3%	0.8	5.4%	215.3	-1.2%
Total 3 days during the holiday		49.4	2.9%	5.7	0.6%	590.1	-1.2%	2.7	-1.8%	647.9	-0.9%

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Source: Citi Research, Ministry of Transport

Tongcheng Travel Holdings

(0780.HK; HK\$13.12; 1; 22 Jun 26; 16:10)

Valuation

We believe PE is appropriate to value Tongcheng to capture strong growth momentum and is consistent with our valuation methodology for its peers. Our target price of HK\$25 is based on 14x non-IFRS 2026E EPS, set at a discount to the historical average of 21x before the pandemic given a slower revs growth profile.

Risks

Key risks that may prevent the share price from reaching our target price include: 1) greater-than-expected competition from OTA peers or other traveling booking channels; 2) heavy reliance on hotel supply from Trip.com; 3) heavy reliance on Tencent's platforms; and 4) worsening macro.

Trip.com Group Ltd

(TCOM.O; US\$45.1; 1; 18 Jun 26; 16:00)

Valuation

Our target price of US\$82 for Trip.com is based on SOTP. We value the core business at ~US\$76/sh based on a 2026E P/E of 20x, applying a 20% premium to the average P/E of other vertical leaders given TCOM's structural overseas expansion story. We apply the target multiple to TCOM's 2026E adj. earnings excluding the profits from equity investments. We value the major equity investments at ~US\$6/sh based on the market caps of the listed names. We employ an SOTP approach to better factor in the value of the investments.

Risks

Downside risks that could prevent the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) a further softening of the China macro environment that affects travel demand; 2) travel demand taking longer than expected to recover; 3) spending and margins turning worse than expected; 4) an intensification of domestic competition; and 5) any significant new outbreaks of Covid-19 or other epidemics.

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Appendix A-1

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Trip.com Group Ltd (TCOM)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Brian Gong



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 05-Sep-23 07:30:07	1	*49.00	38.26
2 22-Feb-24 07:20:06	1	*53.00	44.67
3 01-Apr-24 08:03:49	1	*55.00	46.96
4 21-May-24 07:19:17	1	*66.00	55.83

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5 09-Oct-24 11:57:16	1	*72.00	62.39
6 19-Nov-24 08:50:04	1	*73.00	62.74
7 02-Jan-25 23:25:44	1	*78.00	64.77
8 25-Feb-25 11:46:46	1	*75.00	57.30

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 20-May-25 06:27:17	1	*78.00	63.38
10 28-Aug-25 11:14:59	1	*85.00	75.03
11 18-Nov-25 07:03:01	1	*86.00	72.44
12 29-Jan-26 09:42:02	1	*82.00	62.02

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tongcheng Travel Holdings (0780.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Brian Gong



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 22-Aug-23 17:18:07	1	*25.00	17.20
2 17-Apr-24 12:59:49	1	*26.00	22.05
3 22-May-24 04:37:48	1	*25.00	18.48
4 18-Jul-24 13:00:07	1	*23.00	14.64

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5 20-Aug-24 17:12:48	1	*20.00	13.12
6 19-Nov-24 18:58:56	1	*21.00	17.70
7 20-Mar-25 15:48:36	1	*24.00	18.38
8 16-Apr-25 12:21:19	1	*26.00	22.40

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 18-Aug-25 13:55:41	1	*28.00	19.66
10 21-May-26 16:33:04	1	*25.00	15.68

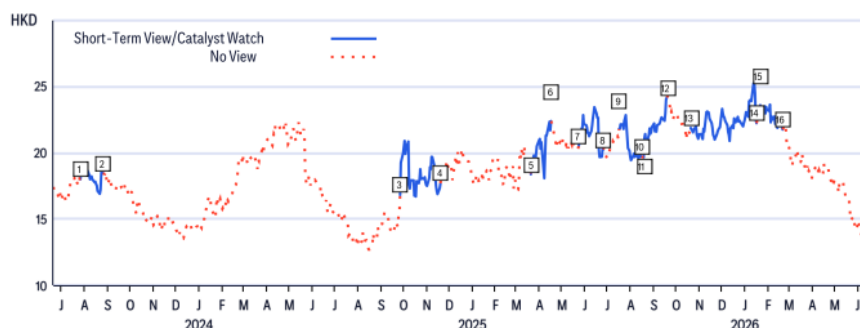
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tongcheng Travel Holdings (0780.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Brian Gong



1	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	26-Jul-23 23:00:00	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	18.00
2	27-Aug-23 13:17:36	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	18.44
3	26-Sep-24 23:35:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	16.82
4	19-Nov-24 13:58:56	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	17.70
5	20-Mar-25 11:48:36	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	18.38
6	16-Apr-25 08:21:19	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	22.40
7	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	25-May-25 16:22:57	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	20.50
8	25-Jun-25 00:26:28	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	20.25
9	16-Jul-25 10:07:34	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	21.80
10	15-Aug-25 14:06:14	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	19.70
11	18-Aug-25 09:55:41	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	19.66
12	18-Sep-25 00:18:07	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	24.18
13	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
13	20-Oct-25 07:56:33	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	21.88
14	18-Jan-26 22:32:24	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	22.24
15	21-Jan-26 08:16:57	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	23.60
16	20-Feb-26 12:03:45	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	21.76

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Trip.com Group Ltd (TCOM)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Brian Gong



1	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	19-Jul-23 12:01:15	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	36.75
2	26-Jul-23 23:00:00	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	38.42
3	26-Aug-23 12:09:28	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	39.15
4	01-Apr-24 04:03:49	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	46.96
5	21-May-24 03:19:17	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	55.83
6	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
6	21-Jul-24 17:40:41	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	45.36
7	26-Sep-24 23:35:15	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	56.68
8	26-Sep-24 23:35:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	56.68
9	26-Dec-24 11:28:59	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	73.06
10	02-Jan-25 18:25:44	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	64.77
11	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
11	25-Feb-25 06:46:46	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	57.30
12	14-Oct-25 07:05:16	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	70.16
13	12-Jan-26 11:04:07	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	78.96

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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